



1 A MATTER OF QUALITY

Good caviar should hold its integrity—each grain should be separate, distinct, and firm

2 PICK THE RIGHT SPOON

Caviar reacts with metal, so use a mother-of-pearl spoon or a simple wooden spoon to have it

3 CAVIAR AND CHAMPAGNE

The crisp acidity and bubbles of Champagne cut through the rich, buttery texture of caviar perfectly, elevating the experience

tin—each grain should be separate, distinct, and firm. When you taste it, the eggs should burst delicately, releasing their flavour as soon as they hit the warmth of your mouth. It should taste clean, fresh, and slightly briny, not fishy or overpowering. If you open a tin and find the caviar to be a mushy mess, chances are it's of poor quality.

How should you eat caviar? There is only one right answer here: by itself. While you've probably seen traditional caviar service with accompaniments such as chopped onions, egg yolks, lemons, and blinis or Melba toast, this was invented in Paris at the beginning of the 20th century to stretch the caviar when there wasn't enough or to mask the fishy taste of sub-par caviar. In fact, true connoisseurs always eat it neat. Try a caviar bump by scooping a generous helping onto the back of your hand and raising it to your mouth like a shot. It's a purist's approach that lets you fully appreciate the flavour. If you're not feeling that brave, add some fat. Put a dollop of crème fraîche or butter on a crisp potato chip and top it with caviar. Keep it simple and let the caviar speak for itself.

Remember, how you store caviar is important. Always store it in your fridge, but never in the freezer—freezing will ruin the delicate texture of the eggs. Once you crack open the tin, the clock starts ticking. You've got about 48 hours to enjoy it at its peak, so don't linger. Do not use a metal spoon. Caviar has an unfortunate reaction to metal, which can affect the taste. A mother-of-pearl spoon is the gold standard, but a simple wooden spoon works just as well. The Russians might prefer vodka, but for me, there's no better pairing than Champagne. The crisp acidity and bubbles of Champagne cut through the rich, buttery texture of the caviar perfectly, balancing the fat and elevating the entire experience. Trust me, it's a match made in heaven.

Now that you're armed with everything there is to know about this ocean treasure, it's time to stop waiting for an excuse. Go ahead, treat yourself to a tin of caviar. And here's the real secret: you don't need a special occasion to open it. The act of opening caviar is itself a special occasion. **BT**

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